

AEP Prep Checklist

Your game plan for a winning Annual Enrollment Period

START NOW, NOT IN OCTOBER

The full thinking lives in “The AEP Game Plan” under Knowledge & Updates. This is the checklist to run it — work through it between now and September.

STEP 1 Stay in front of clients all year

YEAR-ROUND

- ☐ Start a newsletter, physical or digital, on a set cadence.
- ☐ Automate birthday cards and emails.
- ☐ Schedule simple check-ins through the year — a text, an email, a call.
- ☐ Automate every touchpoint you can, so retention runs without you.

STEP 2 Know your book cold

BY SEPTEMBER

- ☐ Pull your Med Supp vs Medicare Advantage split.
 - This is what lets you segment your outreach come early September.
- ☐ Build your carrier breakdown and flag any carrier holding a big share of your book.
 - If they make a big change, those clients get reached first — before a newer agent does.
- ☐ Figure your year-over-year growth.
- ☐ Pinpoint where most of your business actually comes from.
- ☐ Match your prep to your mix — a big Med Supp book preps differently than a DSNP / MAPD book.

STEP 3 Get into advisor mode now

- ☐ Treat every client like they are your only client.
- ☐ Ask everyone you meet who else they know you can help.
- ☐ Over-deliver: listen, know their name, tell them what nobody else bothered to.
- ☐ Do what you said you would do — follow up exactly when you promised.

STEP 4

Out-prepare every appointment

- ☐ Know each client's current plan and exactly what changed for the coming year.
- ☐ Be ready to show how their plan stacks up against the other carriers.
- ☐ Study every plan cold: formulary, copay structure, networks, star rating.

STEP 5

Map your outreach before the mail hits

GET THERE FIRST

- ☐ Decide today how you will reach every client in September.
- ☐ Set your scheduling: phone or in person, and how long each appointment runs.
- ☐ Decide whether you pull doctors and meds before or during the call.
- ☐ Plan how you will walk each client through their plan changes.
- ☐ Frame every recommendation around what is genuinely best for the client.
- ☐ Tell clients early what to expect this AEP — from the market and from you.

THE BOTTOM LINE

AEP is when brokers make their biggest gains, or fall behind. The difference is almost always preparation. Start now — and if you want help building your plan, reach out to the TIG team.